

Five Steps to Financial Wellbeing

many – circles us like an invisible bird of prey, threatening to peck our eyes out if we so much as think about buying an avocado or a takeaway coffee. This in turn makes it almost impossible to talk about money, especially if we feel like we're failing to live up to those standards or have different financial priorities.

So, we're caught between a rock and a hard place, and the more we don't talk about it – the more we keep hidden, the more we try to cover up – the harder it gets to talk about it. A vicious cycle that only ends in everyone feeling alone, even when we have so much of this stuff in common.

We don't want to be patronized

I find that there's an incorrect assumption among a lot of people that, just because you struggle with your relationship with money, you must also be terrible at maths, or ill-informed about personal finance, or both. While it's true that there's a correlation between financial confidence and financial literacy, being infantilized the moment that we mention money worries is not something that appeals to any of us. For people who have always got on just fine with their money, it can be difficult to understand how it feels to have a difficult relationship with it, and that can often manifest in a well-intentioned but hurtful or irritating lecture. There is, generally speaking, a lack of awareness of the connection between money and other factors, even for people who experience it